

DINTONATION

CONSTITUTION AND BYLAWS

Updated Fall 2025

Introduction: Founding

In 2014, senior Emily Lange '15, decided to organize a group of talented, female singers to fill Furman's need, seeing as Furman had both an all-male a cappella group and a co-ed a cappella group. This group was named the Furman Belles. The first concert was held in the Daniel Recital Hall on December 12, 2014 at 8:00pm. During the spring of 2015, the Belles moved the concert location to Harper Hall, which is where concerts are held to this day. A year later, Felicity Williams '19, freshman, became the Public Relations Chair for the Furman Belles. It was the spring concert of 2016 in which this group had its first concert theme, a trademark of the organization. This concert was named *Rebelles*, an outlaw themed concert. Felicity Williams '19 suggested a name change from Belles to Dintonation in order to separate the group from the all-male a cappella group, The Bell Tower Boys, as well as move towards the new direction of the group's image. The members of the group presented the new name to its audience at the Spring 2016 *Rebelles* concert.

Article I: Name

As of Spring 2016, this organization is named Dintonation.

Article II: Purpose

The purpose of Dintonation is twofold:

- i. To produce quality music performances at Furman University.
- ii. To provide motivated students of any major or background with the opportunity to enhance their skills in leadership, performance, music, and expression.

Article III: Membership

- Section i: Dintonation is an auditioned group. Any interested Furman students are welcome to come to our auditions. After accepting the offer to join Dintonation, a student is considered to be a member of Dintonation so long as they attend rehearsals. All members are subject to the terms of this constitution.
- Section ii: Members of Dintonation are eligible to run for the Executive team after completing one full semester of membership. Position elections are held at the end of each year or end of the semester if there is a vacancy.
- Section iii: A member may only take a semester off if they are studying abroad. If a member decides to leave the group for a semester, but remain on campus, they must re-audition if they wish to return.
- Section iv: If a member wishes to leave the group, they must have a meeting with the Music Director and the President about why they wish to leave. If after the meeting the member still wants to leave and it is not an emergency, the member should attend the next two rehearsals to sing their voice part with the member who will be replacing them on that part.
- Section v: If a member of exec leaves the group, the responsibilities of that member will be distributed amongst the remaining exec.

Article IV- The Music Director

- Section i: The Music Director of Dintonation is responsible for planning and leading all rehearsals. Section ii: The Music Director must personally select and/or arrange all of the music for each semester.
- Section iii: The Music Director is the communications liaison between Dintonation and arrangers.
- Section iv: The Music Director must approve of all rehearsals, gigs, and concerts before they are scheduled.
- Section v: The Music Director shares speaking responsibilities at concerts and gigs with the President.
- Section vi: The Music Director counts votes for solo auditions.
- Section vii: The Music Director is responsible for final selection of repertoire, new members, and soloists.
- Section viii: The Music Director must distribute music to the members or delegate this responsibility to someone who can.

Article V- The President

- Section i: The President of Dintonation acts as the face of the organization and should conduct herself

- appropriately.
- Section ii: The President must prepare an agenda for Exec meetings.
- Section iii: The President is the liaison between exec and the group, the music department, Furman University organizations and officials, as well as the outside community.
- Section iv: The President is responsible for relaying information received from SGA back to the executive team.
- Section v: The President is responsible for room reservations.
- Section vi: The President must reregister Dintonation at the beginning of every year.
- Section vii: The President is responsible for maintaining communication with the other a cappella groups on campus.

Article VI- The Vice-President

- Section i: The Vice-President is responsible for managing group attendance as well as enforcing the attendance policy (see Article XII).
- Section ii: The Vice-President must be present at monthly Exec meetings.
- Section iii: The Vice-President must send out emails to members who are excused from meetings.
- Section iv: The Vice-President is responsible for sending out rehearsal schedules to members.
- Section v: The Vice-President must reserve sound equipment for bi-yearly concerts.
- Section vi: The Vice-President is responsible for sending out alumni emails periodically.

Article VII- The Treasurer

- Section i: The Treasurer should give a money report when necessary to the rest of the executive team.
- Section ii: The Treasurer is in charge of making reimbursements to the executive team and payments to arrangers/music distributors in a timely manner.
- Section iii: The Treasurer can reallocate money without the approval of Exec so long as the Treasurer and Music Director are in agreement and the reallocations are approved by SGA.
- Section iv: The Treasurer must allocate and submit a budget to SGA at the end of the school year.

Article VIII- The Public Relations Chair

- Section i: The Public Relations Chair is responsible for publicizing FPP auditions, performances, and other events around the university and in the community
- Section ii: The Public Relations Chair must consistently update social media accounts including but not limited to Facebook and Instagram.
- Must Instagram:
 - o Once every month during rehearsals.
 - o Every day for the three days leading up to a concert.
 - o And for special events.
- Section iii: The Public Relations Chair will create a trifold poster, audition interest forms, and flyers for the Student Involvement Fair in the Fall and may create stickers to pass out as well.
- Section iv: The Public Relations Chair coordinates general Dintonation apparel (T-shirts, hats, etc).
- Section v: The Public Relations Chair decorates Harper Hall, makes seat reservations, and coordinates live-streams for semester concerts.
- Section vi: The Public Relations Chair must store the concert decoration boxes for the remainder of their term.

Article IX- All Exec Team Members

- Section i: All executive team members are responsible for discussing scheduling and music selections.
- Section ii: All executive team members are responsible for maintaining and updating the Constitution and Bylaws.
- Section iii: MuseScore creation can be shared amongst exec members as they are able. At the beginning of the year, every new member of exec will be taught how to create MuseScores by returning exec.

Article X- Executive Meetings

- Section i: Executive meetings will be scheduled to occur once every two weeks. They will be run by the President unless the meeting is called by another member of the Executive board to discuss specific matters.
- Section ii: Meetings will last anywhere from 10 to 30 minutes, depending on the matters to be discussed.

Article XI- Officer Elections

- Section i: To run for one of the four elected positions (President, Vice-President, Treasurer, and Public Relations Chair), a member must be in Dintonation for a whole semester.
- Section ii: Officer elections happen at the end of the academic year, or at the end of Fall semester if there is a vacancy.
- Section iii: The maximum size of Exec is five members and the minimum size of Exec is four members.
- Section iv: Exec members may keep their positions until the graduate, step down, run for a new position, or leave the group unless they are opposed by anyone in the group.
- Section v: The graduating seniors of exec will handle the voting process of elections. If there are no graduating seniors, the member of Exec who has not been opposed and is staying in their position will run the election process. If there are no returning, unopposed members remaining on Exec, the current President will run the election process.
- Section vi: Former officers will teach the newly elected officers about their duties.
- Section vii: If a member wishes to run for a position but will only be on campus for one semester, it is that member's responsibility to find another member to switch with for the semester they will not be on campus.

Article XII- Attendance Policy

- Section i: If a member has a scheduling conflict, whether she cannot not attend a rehearsal or a portion of a rehearsal, that member must contact, by writing, the current Vice-President at LEAST twenty-four hours before said rehearsal (unless it is an emergency, see Section viii).
- Section ii: The absence is ONLY excused when the Vice-President approves it in written form.
- Section iii: If a member has been excused from rehearsal five times, she must sing her parts for the Executive Team.
- Section iv: Dintonation does not allow any unexcused absences. An absence is not excused if the vice-president rejects the excuse or if the vice-president does not respond to the excuse. The result of having an unexcused absence may range from the loss of the right to vote, the loss of a solo(s) or the loss of potential future solos, or, in extreme situations, removal from the group.
- Section v: Excused academic conflicts are limited to required events and meetings scheduled by a member's teacher.
- Section vi: CLPs are not excused absences unless required by a teacher.
- Section vii: No member should be late unless specifically approved by the Vice-President. Being late will affect a member's ability to obtain a solo. One unexcused absence will count as one negative vote during the next soloist voting process. Three unexcused tardies will count as one negative vote during the next soloist voting process.
- Section viii: Unforeseen emotional, physical, and psychological emergencies are excused. However, there still needs to be a dialogue with the Vice-President. The member is not required to attend rehearsal via Zoom, but they may join on Zoom if they wish.
- Section ix: A member may miss up to 4 rehearsals (tech week included) throughout the duration of the show for an organization such as the Furman Pauper Players. The Vice-President must be made aware of the specific dates immediately as they are known.

Article XIII- Auditions for Solos

- Section i: 60% of the executive board must be present for auditions to take place.
- Section ii: Auditions consist of each person interested in auditioning singing the same section of the piece while the rest of the group sings their respective parts. After each interested member has auditioned, all members close their eyes and vote. Each member raises their hand in the air and opens their hand when the person they would like to vote for is mentioned.
- Section iii: The Music Director will run auditions, unless they would like to audition, in which case the President will run auditions. If the President as well is auditioning, then the Vice President will run auditions, and so on.
- Section iv: Based on attendance and unexcused absences from rehearsal, the auditioning member can have votes taken away if too many unexcused absences are documented; for more on this process, refer to Article IX, section iv

